

SLEEP WELL, LIVE BETTER: RETHINKING THE MANAGEMENT OF OBSTRUCTIVE SLEEP APNEA

Obstructive Sleep Apnea is quietly affecting far more people across India than most would expect, and the majority of them have no idea it is happening. It is not just a condition that affects older adults or heavy snorers. Children, teenagers, young adults, and older individuals are all affected, and most of them have no idea why they feel the way they do.

Every time breathing stops during sleep, oxygen levels drop. Over time, that repeated deprivation quietly drives chronic inflammation and physiological stress, setting the stage for hypertension, heart disease, diabetes, and stroke. In children, the signs can look completely different from what most parents would expect. Mouth breathing, restless sleep, bedwetting, hyperactivity, and slipping grades are all things that can point back to disrupted breathing at night. In teenagers and young adults, it tends to show up as persistent fatigue and declining performance at school or work, symptoms that get written off as stress or burnout rather than a sleep disorder.

In adults, loud snoring, breathing pauses, morning headaches, excessive daytime sleepiness, frequent nighttime urination, and irritability are the more recognisable signs. Catching these early makes a real difference. Tools like the STOP-Bang questionnaire help identify risk, and portable home sleep studies now make it possible to screen for moderate to severe OSA without an initial hospital stay.



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PAP therapy remains the clinical gold standard, but keeping patients on it long term is a genuine challenge. The conversation is increasingly shifting toward personalised, multidisciplinary approaches that are built around the individual rather than a single solution.

At Kokilaben Dhirubhai Ambani Hospital, this thinking has shaped what the sleep science centre offers. The approach is built around a PAP-free philosophy, with personalised treatment plans designed to help suitable patients move away from PAP therapy over time. Depending on what a patient needs, that might mean lifestyle changes, custom oral appliances, or surgical intervention, including treatment for enlarged adenoids in children and airway reconstruction in adults.

Treating sleep apnea does more than quiet a snore. It brings down cardiovascular risk, helps stabilise blood pressure, improves energy and productivity, reduces accident risk, and in children, supports the kind of focus that directly affects how they learn and perform. Sleep is not just rest. It is one of the most important things the body does, and when it is disrupted night after night, everything else pays the price.

FOR MORE DETAILS

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